

A FAITHFUL PATH COMMUNITY GUIDE

The Christian Spiritual Reset

*A 3-Day Guided Retreat to Overcome Burnout,
Hear God Clearly, and Renew Your Faith*

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FAITHFUL PATH COMMUNITY

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CHAPTER 17

Your 30-Day Spiritual Renewal Plan

For the whole first month home

The four chapters before this one each cover a piece of the return: testing, action, rhythm, help. This chapter puts them on a calendar, so that the first month home has a shape and you do not have to decide each morning what the retreat asked of you. It is deliberately light. Nothing in it takes more than the daily rhythm and one or two short tasks a week, and every item is adjustable.

Read it once, copy the four weekly blocks into your journal or diary, and return only to the section for the week you are in. The plan is for doing, not for repeated studying.

What the month is for

Three things. First, to let the rhythm from Session Ten become more familiar through a month of imperfect repetition. Thirty days will not necessarily make it automatic; it will show whether it is small and realistic enough to continue. Second, to work through the action cards at a pace that does not recreate the burnout. Third, to give the optional sessions and the testing the time they need, so that what was begun on retreat is finished in ordinary life rather than abandoned there.

It is not for becoming a different person in thirty days. The apostle Paul, who had more reason than most to expect rapid transformation, wrote that "he who began a good work in you will bring it to completion at the day of Jesus Christ" (Philippians 1:6). The day of completion is not Day 30. Day 30 is a review.

One thing that does not wait for the calendar

If any warning sign from Chapter 4 or Chapter 5 applies, if you are in danger, being harmed, unable to function, in severe distress, or dependent on a substance, read Chapter 16 now, on whatever day it is, and act on its guidance. Safety and professional help take priority over every week below.

The daily minimum

Every day of the month, the rhythm from Session Ten's card. That is all that is required daily. If your rhythm is weekly rather than daily, a protected period of ceasing or a weekly hour, then the daily minimum is smaller still: a psalm and a few minutes of quiet, the Chapter 8 practice, on the days you can. When you miss, resume the next day without compensation or guilt.

A psalm for each week, if you want one to return to: Week 1, Psalm 23. Week 2, Psalm 62. Week 3, Psalm 27. Week 4, Psalm 131. They are the ones from Chapter 8, and reading them again at home will show you something about the distance travelled.

Week 1: landing

The soft week. Expect the dip. Do little.

The minimum:

- **Day 1:** read Chapter 13. Sort the cards into the three categories. Take no major action. Do any necessary safety or

care action. Schedule the Eli conversation. Put the review date on the worksheet.

- **This week:** keep the rhythm, imperfectly.
- **Tell your support person** you are home. One conversation, not a report. If capacity allows:
- Read Chapter 14 on Day 2 or 3 and choose the minimum two-week plan.
- Complete one Act card, or one Seek-counsel appointment or access step. If the Seek-counsel step concerns health or safety, it takes priority. Do not pronounce a final verdict on the retreat, announce major conclusions, or redesign your life this week. Notice what happened without forcing an interpretation. Do not begin the rule of life yet.

Week 2: doing

The week the cards leave the pile.

- **This week:** one Share conversation, held, using the three sentences from Chapter 14. The Jethro questions, answered in the journal. If capacity allows, a second Act card.
- **The Eli conversation**, if you are testing anything from Chapter 13. Bring the worksheet.
- **Optional session:** if you left Session Eight for the 30-day plan and want it, this is its week. One sitting, at home, in your quiet time. It is written for exactly this.
- **Read Chapter 15** at the end of the week, and begin thinking about the rule, but do not write it yet.
- **Two-week check on the rhythm:** is it livable? If not, shrink it. Do not abandon it.

Week 3: shaping

The week the rule is written.

- **Write the rule of life** from Chapter 15, using the template, with the three core lines and no more than two optional ones. Put the two-week check and three-month review dates on it. Share it, or the parts you want accountability for, with your Eli.
- **This week:** the structural request from Chapter 14, if capacity allows, taken to whoever can change something. One request.
- **Optional session:** Session Nine, if you left it. Write the purpose sentence and the "one faithful thing." Keep the purpose sentence beside the rule; add the "one faithful thing" to the rule only if it is a sustainable recurring commitment rather than a one-time action.
- **Revisit Chapter 16** whether or not you initially thought it applied. Sometimes a need becomes clearer after several weeks at home. If any of its signs describe you, act on question 4 of that chapter this week.

Week 4: settling

The week of review and, where appropriate, the forgiveness session.

- **Session Six**, only if the conditions at the top of it are met: you are rested and settled, the harm is not active, and you want to explore what release might mean without forcing an outcome. If you are in doubt, use the default short prayer and leave the rest. If the conditions are not met, Session Six is not for this month, and possibly not for this year, and that is a legitimate decision. Consider doing it in a supported setting rather than alone.
- **The Chapter 13 review**, if you are testing a major direction: revisit the worksheet with the time now given. If the testing

supports a small, responsible, reversible step, consider taking that step. If the decision still requires more time, expertise, consultation, or factual information, continue testing beyond Day 30. Day 30 is not a decision deadline.

- **Day 30:** the review below.

The Day 30 review

Sit down for an hour, with the journal, the cards, the intention from Chapter 7, and your Chapter 1 answers. Not to grade the month, but to see it.

1. **Grace received.** Where did you notice help, kindness, provision, truth, rest, or God's presence during the month? What happened that you did not produce through effort? Begin here, before anything is evaluated.
2. **The intention.** Read it again, all four parts. Session Ten asked what had shifted after three days. Ask again after thirty. What has become clearer, and what still needs attention?
3. **The Chapter 1 answers.** When did you last feel close to God on your own; what have you kept doing while feeling nothing; what was your "It is enough." Read them beside where you are now. Do not force a conclusion. Notice.
4. **The rhythm.** How often did you keep it? What helped it happen? What repeatedly prevented it? Did it become easier, more natural, or more life-giving? Use the answers to keep, shrink, move, or replace it.
5. **The cards.** Which became actions, conversations, help, or release? Of those remaining, which should move to the "To test" pile, which need a different kind of help, and which can simply be let go?
6. **The unresolved.** What remains open without needing to be forced? Name it, and leave it named.

7. **The help.** If Chapter 16 applied, did you act? If not, what is the one step this week?
8. **The next pause.** Session Ten asked what the next deliberate pause would be. Book it now: a three-hour reset next month, a day in three months, a full retreat within the year. A rhythm needs a next time, and the calendar is where rhythms survive. If you wrote a purpose sentence in Session Nine, read it too. Does it still fit? Rewrite it if the season has changed.

Write one paragraph, dated, at the end of the review: what the month has been. Then close the journal. The month is finished.

If you missed most of it

Some readers will reach Day 30 having done a fraction of this. Illness, a family crisis, a work emergency, or simply the dip lasting longer than expected will have taken the month. If that is you, two things.

First, the plan does not expire, and it does not need restarting from the beginning. Do not restart automatically. Look at the four blocks and identify the next unfinished step that still matters. Begin there. If you need the gentleness of the landing week again, take it; otherwise continue without trying to recreate a perfect month. The cards keep. The sessions keep. The intention keeps.

Second, ask whether the fraction you did was the important part. Many readers who "missed the plan" kept the rhythm on some days, made one appointment, had one conversation. Those are not a fraction of the plan. They are the plan, in the form your month allowed. Chapter 14 said that doing the word is a habit built by resuming, not by never failing. Resume.

A closing word

You began this book tired in a place that sleep does not reach. You took days you probably felt you could not afford, and you spent them being honest with God about what you were carrying, and letting him carry some of it. You returned to ordinary life, perhaps to many of the same demands, perhaps to changes that could no longer be postponed, and you have begun learning to carry what is yours differently.

I do not know what the month has been for you, and I have tried not to promise what I could not. But I can tell you what the pattern is, because it has been the pattern from the first page. God fed Elijah before he sent him. He let him sleep. He asked him what he was doing there, and listened to the answer, twice. He reoriented him, gave him work that was his to do, and gave him a companion and a successor. He did not tell him to try harder.

That is still the pattern. Go on your way, and go with others. Work when it is yours to work. Stop when it is time to stop. The world is held by God, not by you.

The Lord bless you and keep you.